



Sikkim Democratic Front

Sikkim Democratic Front (**SDF**) is a regional political party in the [Indian state](#) of [Sikkim](#). It was the ruling party in [Sikkim](#) from 12 December 1994 to 23 May 2019.

History

The party was founded by [Pawan Kumar Chamling](#) in 1993. It has ruled the Sikkim state from 1994 to 2019 with Pawan Kumar Chamling as the [chief minister](#). The party consolidated its position sweeping the 1999 and 2004 state elections. It won 31 of the 32 assembly seats in the 2004 election.^[2] In the 2009 assembly election, the party made a clean sweep, winning all 32 seats. It also retained the lone [Lok Sabha](#) seat.^[3] In 2014 assembly elections, SDF won 22 seats and retained power.

In May 2016, after the BJP led NDA formed its first government in [Assam](#), a new alliance called the [North-East Democratic Alliance](#) (NEDA) was formed with BJP leader [Himanta Biswa Sarma](#) as its convener.^[4] The Chief Ministers of the north eastern states of [Sikkim](#), [Assam](#), [Manipur](#), [Arunachal Pradesh](#) and [Nagaland](#) too belong to this alliance. Thus, the Sikkim Democratic Front joined the NDA led NEDA.^[5]

[Pawan Kumar Chamling](#) resigned as CM after [2019 Sikkim Legislative Assembly election](#) as former member [Prem Singh Tamang](#)'s [Sikkim Krantikari Morcha](#) party formed the government by winning 17 seats out of 32. SDF party won the remaining 15 seats. But in August 2019, 10 MLAs quit his party to join the [Bharatiya Janata Party](#) and in the same month two other legislators joined [Sikkim Krantikari Morcha](#). Thus making [Pawan Kumar Chamling](#) the only MLA of his party.^{[6][7][8]} The party won only 1 seat in the [2024 Sikkim Legislative Assembly election](#), with former CM [Pawan Kumar Chamling](#) losing the election from both the seats he contested. Later, its only MLA defected to [Sikkim Krantikari Morcha](#), thus reducing its strength in the legislative assembly to zero.^[9]

Sikkim Democratic Front



President	Pawan Kumar Chamling
Founded	4 March 1993
Headquarters	S.D.F Bhawan, Indira Bypass Gangtok, Sikkim
ECI Status	State Party ^[1]
Alliance	National Democratic Alliance (2014-2019) Federal Front (2019)
Seats in Rajya Sabha	0 / 245
Seats in Lok Sabha	0 / 543
Seats in Sikkim Legislative Assembly	0 / 32
Election symbol	



Frontal Organisation

- Youth Wing
- Student's Wing
- Women's Wing
- Labour Wing
- Cultivators and Organic Farmers Wing
- Ex-servicemen Wing
- Scheduled Tribe Welfare Wing
- Scheduled Caste Welfare Wing
- Drivers Wing
- Traders Wing

List of Chief Minister

No	Name	Term		Tenure
1	Pawan Kumar Chamling (MLA from Namchi-Singhithang)	12 December 1994	23 May 2019	24 years, 162 days

Electoral records

Sikkim Legislative Assembly election

Year	Total Seats	Seats Contested	Seats Won	Forfeited Deposits	% Votes contested	Source
1994	32	32	19	1	42.00	[10]
1999	32	31	24	0	52.83	[11]
2004	32	32	31	0	71.09	[12]
2009	32	32	32	0	67.52	[13]
2009 (by-election)	1	1	1	0	80.77	[14]
2014	32	32	22	0	56.74	[15]
2014 (by-election)	1	1	0	0	43.68	[16]
2017 (by-election)	1	1	1	0	90.15	[17]
2019	32	32	15	0	47.63	[18]
2019 (by-election)	3	3	0	3	15.18	[19] [20] [21]
2024	32	32	1	5	27.37	[22] [23]

Lok Sabha election, Sikkim

Year	Total Seats	Seats Contested	Seats Won	Forfeited Deposits	% Votes contested	Source
<u>1996</u>	1	1	1	0	72.15	[24]
<u>1998</u>	1	1	1	0	65.72	[25]
<u>1999</u>	1	1	1	0	52.56	[26]
<u>2004</u>	1	1	1	0	69.84	[27]
<u>2009</u>	1	1	1	0	63.30	[28]
<u>2014</u>	1	1	1	0	52.98	[29]
<u>2019</u>	1	1	0	0	43.92	[30]
<u>2024</u>	1	1	0	0	20.05	[31]

See also

- List of political parties in India
- Elections in Sikkim

External links

- Chief Electoral Officer, Sikkim (<http://ceosikkim.nic.in/>)
- Sikkim Assembly, Sikkim (<https://sikkimassembly.org.in/>)

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